

ChargePoint

Company Overview and Demand Response Program

1. Company Overview

ChargePoint Holdings, Inc. has positioned itself as a leader in electric vehicle (EV) charging innovation since its founding in 2007, well before EVs became widely available. The company describes itself not as a charging station company but as a technology company — its software-led, hardware-enabled platform is purpose-built for electrified transportation.

The ChargePoint Platform spans commercial, fleet, and residential charging segments across North America and Europe. ChargePoint's business model is capital-light: it builds and sells EV charging hardware, software, and services, but does not own the charging assets themselves — customers own and operate the infrastructure, while ChargePoint provides the technology layer.

Networked Charging Systems are connected through cloud-based software services that allow charging station owners (“hosts”) to manage their stations, and allow drivers to locate, reserve, authenticate, and pay for charging sessions. The platform integrates with hardware from ChargePoint and other manufacturers over an open, intelligent network.

Key Offerings

- Networked AC and DC fast charging stations for businesses, fleets, and homes (e.g., CP6000, Express Plus, Express 280, Next-Gen Express, ChargePoint Home Flex)
- Cloud-based ChargePoint Platform for station management, analytics, AI-assisted operations, and billing
- Dynamic Load Management for real-time monitoring and balancing of site-wide electrical loads
- Mobile app and driver tools for finding, reserving, and paying for charging
- Fleet management and telematics solutions
- Open API and 40+ turnkey integrations, including grid-services and energy-management partners

Market Position

ChargePoint operates one of the largest EV charging networks in the world, with a strong leadership position in North America and a growing presence in Europe. The company highlights a long-term opportunity in the “intelligence layer” built on top of its charging network — including energy dispatch, fleet scheduling, grid services, autonomous vehicle charging, and demand response — framing each charging port as a data node and each software subscription as a recurring revenue stream.

2. What Is Demand Response?

Demand response refers to programs run by utility companies to reduce electricity usage during periods of high demand (“peak events”), rather than relying on adding more power generation capacity. By temporarily reducing demand from connected devices — such as air conditioners, water heaters, and EV chargers — utilities can avoid blackouts, ease strain on the grid, reduce reliance on older, higher-emission backup power plants, and help keep energy costs stable.

EV chargers are well-suited to demand response because charging can often be paused, delayed, or throttled for a short period without significantly affecting the driver, since most vehicles do not need to charge at full power continuously.

3. ChargePoint's Demand Response Capabilities

3.1 Residential: Home Charger Demand Response

ChargePoint partners with utilities and grid-edge technology providers to enroll owners of ChargePoint home chargers (such as the ChargePoint Home Flex) in utility demand response programs. One example is a collaboration between ChargePoint and AutoGrid on a demand response program offered through Pacific Gas & Electric (PG&E).

How it works for residential customers:

- The driver registers their ChargePoint home charger in the utility's demand response program
- During a declared demand response event, the grid-services partner (e.g., AutoGrid) remotely throttles down the power flowing to the charger
- The vehicle continues charging, but at a reduced rate, for the duration of the event
- Participants may receive a financial incentive from the utility for enrolling and participating
- Customers can typically unenroll at any time through the utility or program administrator

Programs of this type are often run in partnership with regional grid operators. For example, in some New England utility programs (delivered through the ConnectedSolutions framework), demand response events are scheduled to coincide with system peak hours, with the highest number of events typically called during July and August. Notifications of upcoming events are sent to participants through the ChargePoint app or by other notification methods.

3.2 Commercial & Fleet: Demand Response and Dynamic Load Management

For businesses, fleets, and site hosts, ChargePoint offers power-management tools within the ChargePoint Platform that support demand response and peak-shaving at the site level:

- Dynamic Load Management (DLM): A cloud-based solution combining an energy gateway, a smart electricity meter, and a router to continuously monitor a site's energy consumption in real time, identify areas of high and low demand, and dynamically redistribute power across charging stations
- Demand Response (port-level control): Allows operators to set a power limit on each individual charging port — for example, an absolute maximum output per port — to shed load during peak periods
- Power Sharing: Sets aggregate power limits across a group of stations, useful when fine-grained, per-port control isn't required
- Scheduled Charging / Time of Use: Lets operators enable or disable charging during certain hours on a recurring weekly schedule, or override the schedule with one-time events, to shift charging away from peak-price or peak-demand periods

Together, these tools help site hosts avoid costly demand charges, reduce stress on local electrical infrastructure, participate in utility demand response and incentive programs, and integrate with renewable energy availability and utility pricing signals.

3.3 Platform-Level Integration

The latest generation of the ChargePoint Platform extends these capabilities with real-time load balancing, demand response integration, renewable energy compatibility, utility pricing-signal support, and flexible rule-based pricing that can adjust rates based on demand or energy costs. The platform is built to be open and OCPP-compliant, enabling onboarding of third-party charging hardware alongside ChargePoint's own stations.

4. Benefits of Participating in Demand Response

- Grid resilience: Helps utilities avoid blackouts and reduces reliance on high-emission backup power plants during peak demand
- Environmental impact: Supports lower overall greenhouse gas emissions by reducing the need for peaker plants
- Cost savings: Site hosts can reduce demand charges and avoid expensive peak-period electricity costs
- Financial incentives: Both residential and commercial participants may be eligible for incentive payments from their utility for enrolling in demand response programs
- Minimal disruption: Charging is throttled or rescheduled rather than stopped outright, so vehicles still receive a charge

5. Summary Table

Aspect	Details
Founded	2007
Core business	Networked EV charging hardware, software (ChargePoint Platform), and services for residential, commercial, and fleet customers
Geographic reach	North America and Europe
Residential DR	Home charger enrollment in utility demand response programs (e.g., with AutoGrid for PG&E); charger power is throttled during peak events, often with an incentive payment
Commercial/Fleet DR	Dynamic Load Management, port-level power limits, power sharing, and scheduled/time-of-use charging to shed load and respond to grid signals
Key value proposition	Combines charging infrastructure with an intelligence layer enabling energy dispatch, grid services, and demand response across its network

Sources: ChargePoint corporate resources (chargepoint.com), ChargePoint product documentation, and ChargePoint Holdings, Inc. SEC filings (Form 10-Q, 8-K, ARS, and DEF 14A, fiscal year 2026).